

Four days, not one lunch.



THE WEEKEND — It is a four-day weekend, so plan four days

WHICH DAY	WHAT HAPPENS	WHO IS HERE
Good Friday		
Saturday		
Easter Sunday		
Easter Monday		

THE HOUSE

Where we are

Adults Children

Staying over

Travelling on

Lunch on Sunday at

WHO CANNOT EAT WHAT — Milk, nuts and soya

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Buy the eggs early, hide them from yourself

The good chocolate sells out in the last week and the shops are shut on the Sunday in a lot of places. Buy in the fortnight before, put it somewhere you would not casually open, and write on page 4 what is meant for whom — otherwise half of it is eaten before Friday and you buy it twice.

ORDERED OR BOOKED — Lamb, a table, a service, a train

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WHAT WE ALWAYS DO — The bit that makes it Easter here

WHAT WE ARE SKIPPING THIS YEAR

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The hunt, worked out.

Date _____



2/9

HOW MANY EGGS, BY AGE — Tick the row for your youngest

AGE	EGGS EACH	HOW HIDDEN
☐ Under 3	8 – 10 each	In sight, at knee height
☐ 3 – 5	12 – 15 each	Low, but hidden
☐ 6 – 9	18 – 20 each	Properly hidden
☐ 10 and up	20 – 25 each	Hard, and a clue or two

Children hunting _____

Eggs each _____

Eggs to buy _____

ZONES, SO THE LITTLE ONES STAND A CHANCE —

WHO _____ WHERE THEY MAY LOOK _____

BEFORE THEY GO OUT —

- ☐ Coats and shoes on before the sugar
- ☐ One basket or bag each, named
- ☐ A camera or a phone that is charged
- ☐ The rules said out loud, once

Three rules, said out loud before they start

Count the eggs before you hide them, or you will never know when it is finished. Give the youngest a head start and a colour or an area of their own. And say the rule that prevents the tears: **nobody eats anything until the whole basket is counted.**

THE RULES FOR THIS HOUSE —

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

TIMING —

Hidden by _____ Starts _____

If it rains, indoors from _____

NOT CHOCOLATE, FOR WHOEVER CANNOT —

- ☐ Plastic eggs with a coin or a sticker inside
- ☐ Dairy-free chocolate, bought separately and marked
- ☐ A small toy, so nobody is counting who got less

Where they are hidden.

SKETCH THE GARDEN OR THE ROOM Number the places as...

Draw it roughly — the fence, the door, the tree, the sofa. It only has to be good enough for you to read at the end.

THE LIST Hidden, then found

#	HIDING PLACE	HID	FOUND
01		☐	☐
02		☐	☐
03		☐	☐
04		☐	☐
05		☐	☐
06		☐	☐
07		☐	☐
08		☐	☐
09		☐	☐
10		☐	☐
11		☐	☐
12		☐	☐
13		☐	☐
14		☐	☐
15		☐	☐
16		☐	☐
17		☐	☐
18		☐	☐
19		☐	☐
20		☐	☐
21		☐	☐
22		☐	☐
23		☐	☐
24		☐	☐

This is the page nobody else sells, and the one you will use

Write down every hiding place as you hide it, and tick it off as it is found. Whatever is still unticked at the end of the morning is the chocolate that turns up behind a radiator in July, or under a hedge in a state nobody wants to describe. Two minutes with a pen now.

Baskets, and the bill.

ONE ROW PER CHILD

The non-chocolate column stops the crash at eleven

WHO	CHOCOLATE	NOT CHOCOLATE	COST	GOT
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				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

BUDGETED	SPENT	LEFT
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Baskets go up, every year, for no reason

They start as one egg and end as a hamper because each adult buys separately and nobody sees the total. Fill in the cost column before you shop, not after. If several people are buying, photograph this page and send it — it is the cheapest conversation you will have this month.

Sunday lunch.

THE TABLE

DISHWHO

GOT

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		☐
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		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

PUDDING

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		☐
		☐
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		☐

DRINK

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		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

THE MEAT, AND WHEN IT RESTS

It needs a rest either ...

What it is

WeightIn at

Out atCarve at

The rest is not optional, and it is your free half hour

Meat out of the oven wants twenty to thirty minutes loosely covered — and that half hour is when the potatoes crisp, the gravy is finished and the table is laid. Plan it in rather than discovering it. Use a thermometer if you have one; time and colour are both worse guesses.

WHILE IT RESTS

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PEOPLE ARRIVING MID-AFTERNOON

Feed the late o...

The other three days.

Date 6/9

Good Friday	Saturday	Easter Monday
☐ Quiet, and no cooking that needs the oven	☐ Dyeing or decorating eggs — newspaper down first	☐ A walk, or somewhere outside
☐ Fish, if that is what you do	☐ Baking, with whoever wants to help	☐ Leftovers, and nothing cooked from scratch
☐ The travelling, if anyone is coming to you	☐ Everything for Sunday that can be made today	☐ The drive home, before it gets busy
☐ Buy the fresh things while the shops are open	☐ Eggs counted, and the hiding places chosen	☐ The chocolate, rationed and put somewhere
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐

Four days of children.

THE PLAN

One thing a day is plenty; two is ambitious

WHATWHAT IT NEEDSWHICH DAYDONE

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			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

DYEING EGGS, WITHOUT THE DISASTER

- ☐ Hard-boil more than you need; some will crack
- ☐ Newspaper, old clothes, and a bowl each
- ☐ Vinegar in the water makes the colour hold
- ☐ Somewhere they can dry without being touched

OUTSIDE, WHATEVER THE WEATHER

FOR THE TWENTY MINUTES BEFORE LUNCH

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BOUGHT OR BORROWED FOR THE WEEKEND

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WHOEVER IS HERE WITHOUT CHILDREN

Beds and the driving.

WHO IS SLEEPING WHERE, AND WHICH NIGHTS

WHO	WHERE	FRI	SAT	SUN	BED
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		☐	☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐	☐
		☐	☐	☐	☐

COMING AND GOING

WHO	ARRIVES	LEAVES
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THINGS GUESTS NEED AND NEVER BRING

☐ A spare toothbrush, and towels out

☐ A charger by the bed

☐ Wellingtons and coats, in every size you have

☐ Somewhere for a travel cot, if there is one

SHOPS SHUT, CHEMISTS SHUT

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THE HOUSE, BEFORE ANYONE ARRIVES

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Tuesday.

THE CHOCOLATE, HONESTLY ————— Rationing works

- ☐ Each child's stash into one named box or bag
- ☐ Out of sight, and out of reach
- ☐ One piece a day, agreed out loud and in advance
- ☐ Anything broken or unwrapped, into the baking cupboard
- ☐ What nobody likes, given away without ceremony

FOOD THAT HAS TO BE EATEN THIS WEEK —————

STILL NOT FOUND ————— From page 3 — go and look now

- ☐ —————
- ☐ —————
- ☐ —————
- ☐ —————

Half price from tomorrow

Chocolate, decorations, baskets and the plastic eggs are all reduced the moment Easter is over. Buy next year's non-food items now — the eggs will not keep, but the baskets, the ribbon and the plastic eggs will, and they go in the same box as the decorations with a label on the lid.

BOUGHT IN THE SALES, IN THE BOX —————

- ☐ —————
- ☐ —————
- ☐ —————
- ☐ —————

THANK YOU —————

TO	FOR	SENT
—————	—————	☐
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NEXT YEAR, THREE LINES ————— Worth ten in March